

Multiple-Choice Elimination Technique — Part 1

Name: _____

Date: _____

Time: **60 min**

1 · COPY THIS DOWN — NOTES, STRUCTURES & TECHNIQUE

THE PROBLEM

In a good multiple-choice question, more than one option will "sound" plausible. Guessing from a gut feeling loses marks — elimination wins them.

4 COMMON DISTRACTOR TYPES — COPY THE LIST

- **Too specific:** adds a detail the text never actually states
- **Right words, wrong meaning:** uses vocabulary from the passage but twists what it means
- **Partially true:** half-correct, but one part is wrong or unsupported
- **Opposite:** states the reverse of what the text says

TECHNIQUE — 4 STEPS

1. Cover the options; answer the question in your own words first
2. Reveal the options; find the one closest to your own answer
3. For each remaining option, find the exact reason it's wrong (name the distractor type)
4. Only pick "best fits" if truly nothing else is fully supported by the text

2 · PRACTICE — 4 PASSAGES, 20 QUESTIONS

EXTRACT A

Kofi had rehearsed his speech forty times, but stepping onto the stage, every line he'd memorised seemed to vanish at once.

1. What best describes how Kofi feels? A) Confident B) Blank with nerves C) Angry at himself D) Bored — identify the correct answer.

2. Which option is a "too specific" distractor and why?

3. Which option is the "opposite" distractor?

4. Explain in one sentence why the correct answer is fully supported by the text.

5. Which exact phrase in the passage supports the correct answer?

EXTRACT B

The committee approved the funding, though two members noted, for the record, that they still had reservations about the timeline.

6. Was the funding decision unanimous? A) Yes, fully B) No, it was rejected C) Approved, but not without disagreement D) Postponed — identify the correct answer.

7. Which option is "right words, wrong meaning" and why?

8. Which option is "opposite"?

9. Which option is unsupported ("postponed") and why?

10. Quote the phrase that proves reservations were recorded, not ignored.

EXTRACT C

Amara didn't say no exactly — she just kept finding reasons the timing wasn't quite right, month after month.

11. What does this suggest about Amara's real feelings? A) She is enthusiastic B) She is quietly reluctant C) She has already refused directly D) She hasn't been asked — identify the correct answer.

12. Which option is "opposite" of the correct meaning?

13. Which option is "too specific" (states something not in the text)?

14. Why is "quietly reluctant" the best-supported option?

15. Quote the evidence that supports it.

EXTRACT D

The bridge was closed for three weeks for repairs, though officials admitted the work could have been finished in half that time with more staff.

16. Why did the closure last three weeks? A) Repairs always take this long B) Understaffing slowed the work C) The bridge was more damaged than planned D) Weather delayed it — identify the correct answer.

17. Which option is "partially true" — sounds close but isn't stated?

18. Which option is entirely unsupported in the text?

19. Quote the exact phrase that supports the correct answer.

20. Explain why "the bridge was more damaged than planned" (C) is a distractor, not the answer.

Apply this every time: Never pick an option just because it "sounds right" — for every option you reject, be able to say exactly why (too specific / wrong meaning / partially true / opposite).

MARKING NOTES (FOR THE TUTOR)

1. B
2. A — "confident" contradicts the passage
3. A (confident) is the opposite
4. The text explicitly says his lines "vanished"

5. "seemed to vanish at once"
6. C
7. A — sounds close but ignores reservations
8. B (rejected)

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| 9. Not mentioned anywhere in text | 15. "kept finding reasons... month after month" |
| 10. "noted, for the record, that they still had reservations" | 16. B |
| 11. B | 17. A — sounds plausible but not stated |
| 12. A (enthusiastic) | 18. D (weather) — never mentioned |
| 13. C — text never says a direct refusal happened | 19. "with more staff" implies understaffing was the cause |
| 14. Matches the evasive, repeated delaying pattern | 20. Never stated in the passage — a distractor invented detail |